

$$x(t) = A_0 e^{-t/\tau} \cos(2\pi f t + \phi) + c$$

phase-coherent single-exponential model used by every coherent fit

constant f



does f hold
across the window?

assumption

single τ



is one decay time
enough?

assumption

decays to zero



does the amplitude
reach the noise floor?

assumption

broadband noise: 1.3–1.9 cycles RMS against a 600-cycle release (SNR $\approx$ 400)